

NIRMAAN MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026

IIA

AGENDA:

Assessment of foreign interference through cyber operations, disinformation networks, and proxy digital actors destabilising domestic political systems.

1. COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The International Intelligence Agency (IIA) is an advanced crisis committee simulating the world of intelligence operations, cyber warfare, and geopolitical strategy. Delegates act as intelligence operatives representing their nations' security apparatus.

This committee demands quick thinking, strategic planning, crisis response, and deep knowledge of international security. Expect continuous crisis updates, directives, and unconventional challenges.

2. KEY CONCEPTS

CYBER OPERATIONS · State-sponsored hacking activities targeting foreign governments, militaries, critical infrastructure, or private entities.

DISINFORMATION NETWORKS · Coordinated campaigns using fake accounts, bot farms, fabricated media, and manipulated narratives to influence public opinion.

PROXY DIGITAL ACTORS · Non-state entities (hactivist groups, private intelligence firms, mercenary cyber units) operating on behalf of state interests while providing plausible deniability.

INFORMATION WARFARE · The strategic use of information to gain competitive advantage, including propaganda, psychological operations, and media manipulation.

3. DOCUMENTED OPERATIONS

RUSSIAN OPERATIONS:

- Internet Research Agency (IRA) · "troll factory" in St. Petersburg that ran social media influence campaigns targeting the 2016 US election
- "Doppelganger" network · Created fake versions of legitimate European news websites to spread pro-Russian narratives (2022-present)
- SolarWinds hack (2020) · Compromised 18,000 organizations including US government agencies through supply-chain attack
- NotPetya (2017) · Destructive malware disguised as ransomware, caused \$10B+ in global damage

CHINESE OPERATIONS:

- "Spamouflage" · Largest known influence operation using networks of fake social media accounts across multiple platforms
- APT groups (APT1, APT10, APT41) · Long-running cyber espionage campaigns targeting intellectual property
- TikTok data collection concerns and content moderation influence

IRANIAN OPERATIONS:

- Hack-and-leak operations targeting 2024 US presidential campaign
- "Charming Kitten" (APT35) · Phishing campaigns targeting journalists, activists, and government officials
- Cyberattacks on critical infrastructure: attempted hack of New York dam (2013), water treatment facilities

NORTH KOREAN OPERATIONS:

- Lazarus Group · \$1.5B+ in cryptocurrency theft to fund weapons programs
- WannaCry ransomware (2017) · Infected 200,000+ systems in 150 countries
- Sony Pictures hack (2014) · In retaliation for "The Interview" film

4. COUNTERMEASURES AND FRAMEWORKS

INTERNATIONAL:

- Budapest Convention on Cybercrime (2001) · First international treaty on internet crime
- Tallinn Manual · Academic study on how international law applies to cyber operations
- UN Group of Governmental Experts (GGE) reports on norms for state behavior in cyberspace
- Paris Call for Trust and Security in Cyberspace (2018)

INTELLIGENCE ALLIANCES:

- Five Eyes (USA, UK, Canada, Australia, New Zealand) · Signals intelligence sharing
- NATO Cooperative Cyber Defence Centre of Excellence (CCDCOE) · Tallinn, Estonia
- EU Cyber Diplomacy Toolbox · Framework for joint EU responses to cyber threats

AI AND DEEPPFAKES:

- Generative AI has lowered the barrier for creating convincing disinformation
- 96% increase in deepfake content online between 2022-2024
- AI-generated voice cloning used in political robocalls (2024 US primaries)

5. POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

1. Your country's cyber capabilities and intelligence infrastructure
2. Known incidents involving your country (as target or suspected actor)
3. Your country's position on international cyber norms
4. Proposed strategies for protecting domestic political systems

KEY QUESTIONS:

- Should offensive cyber operations be subject to IHL principles?
- How should states attribute cyber attacks and what thresholds justify response?
- What role should private tech companies play in combating state-sponsored disinformation?
- Should there be an international treaty governing state behavior in cyberspace?